Aunil Muntazir

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Home: (Malta)

ABOUT ME

Working for over 6 years with children from adverse backgrounds in various capacities, focusing on resilience curriculums for low-resource community schools and out-of-school children. Interested in finding practical ways to close learning gaps, maximize limited resources, and enhance learning through play-based activities. Additionally, exploring ways to include the voices and needs of low-income families in education policies to make them more meaningful and fair.

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Malta – Malta

Website: https://www.um.edu.mt/

Project Support Officer

[09/2025 – Current]

The Pre-Award team supports academics in the budgetary preparation of research project proposals, applying for approximately EUR 110 million annually. The Post-Award team currently manages over 400 active externally funded research projects having various areas of specialization, with a value of EUR 45 million. The team currently comprises 28 members of staff across the Pre and Post award teams. The Project Support Officer will be responsible for the budgeting and financial coordination, and administration of a portfolio of high-value externally funded projects mainly from the European Union and other funding bodies.

Mainly:
• Draft budgets for new project proposals and coordinate information for the review of such proposals;
• Ensure the smooth transition of projects from the pre-award phase to the post-award phase;
• Liaise with the project coordinator and other departments to ensure internal and external compliance;
• Liaise with other project partners at the local and international level on the projects;
• Carry out the necessary administrative and financial tasks in relation to the projects;
• Maintain and monitor all the necessary documentation and upkeep of the project files;
• Check, process and monitor documentation representing project expenditure;
• Ensure adherence to policies and procedures adopted by the University and/or specific funding programmes;
• Prepare financial reports and any other project-related reports as per programme regulations;
• Liaise with external auditors and assist the project coordinator during project audits and on-the-spot checks;
• Check and process timesheets of staff working on the project;
• Monitor and manage the disbursement of funds.

SANTA CASA DA MISERICÓRDIA DE LISBOA (Foster Home) – Lisbon, Portugal

Website: https://scml.pt/acao-social/infancia-e-juventude/

Project assistant (Intern)

[06/2024 – 07/2025]

- Support 12 educators working in shifts to implement RESCUR, the European Union's resilience and socio-emotional learning curriculum, for 18 children at the foster home.
- Conduct debriefs with the teachers, children, and program supervisor.
- Observe sessions to provide feedback to maintain the quality and fidelity of the program.
- Evaluate protective and risk factors among 12 educators and 8 staff members.
- Coordinate research with 19 foster homes in Lisbon to evaluate resilience and stress among their staff.
- Implement strategies to identify and develop primary support figures in the lives of foster children.

Malta Human Rights Education Centre – Malta

Website: https://maltahrec.com/

Operations Volunteer (Intern)

[01/11/2023 – 29/02/2024]

- Research on CSR programs.
- Brainstorm and draft activity proposals for summer 2024 activities with children.
- Emailed Agenda and other bookshops to donate books to MHREC.

Cities for Children – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://www.citiesforchildren.co/

Programme Consultant (Part-Time)

[01/01/2023 – 09/2023]

Cities for Children is a UK-registered INGO primarily operating in Pakistan, dedicated to creating social and material environments that support the development and well-being of children in urban areas. Its focus includes street-connected children, working children, and those from displaced or migrant communities.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Coordinated with the Ministry of Human Rights and Child Rights Caucus, the government of Pakistan, in developing teacher training programs against corporal punishment and alternate classroom management methods in under-resourced public schools.
- Led sessions on 'Maar Nahi Pyaar,' an anti-corporal punishment initiative for parents and caregivers, and trained teachers on alternative classroom management strategies in 11 low-income public schools.
- Led and conducted Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL) for *Hasti Basti* (Happy Hood), a flagship program for street children in Islamabad and Rawalpindi. Collaborated with 3 universities in Islamabad to involve over 55 graduating students as volunteers for its implementation.
- Conducted MEL activities for post-flood intervention programs at various Temporary Learning Centres (TLCs) in interior Sindh and conducted several Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) with over 150 out-of-school children, 50 parents, and 12 teachers.
- Implemented the University of Oxford and UNICEF Lifelong Parenting Intervention Program for internally displaced parents in emergency contexts. Trained over 30 teachers and support staff to deliver Parenting for Lifelong sessions and collaborated with the MEL team in evaluation and feedback processes.
- Collaborated with the Reform Support Unit (RSU) and local government to reintegrate over 100 out-of-school children displaced by flooding into mainstream public schools. Coordinated with local authorities to facilitate the issuance of essential documents, including birth certificates and parents' national identity cards, required for school admissions.
- Conducted impact evaluation of the flagship program 'Sekho Sekhao Sathi' through FDGs with over 60 children, 25 parents, and 10 educators on-site to ensure their voices were incorporated into the program's development and implementation.
- Provided support in supervising, reviewing, conducting, and evaluating training and on-site learning programs in partnered public and private schools, with a focus on children from under-resourced communities, including slum residents, street children, working children, and those from displaced or migrant families.

The Citizens Foundation – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://www.tcf.org.pk/

Curriculum Development Specialist

[01/07/2022 – 31/08/2023]

The Citizens Foundation (TCF) is one of Pakistan's largest privately owned networks of low-cost formal schools in rural and low-income communities. It operates a network of 1,833 school units, educating 280,000 students through over 13,000 teachers and principals.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Collaboratively reviewed and developed TCF's Urdu-language math textbooks for grades 1 to 5.
- Designed, developed, and reviewed curricula, schemes of studies, teachers' guides, and lesson plans, including SEL activities in Urdu.

- Evaluated and assessed existing curricula and instructional quality while collaborating with primary school teachers and school administrations in public and private schools across underserved communities in Sindh, Punjab, and KPK.
- Conducted classroom observations every month to provide pedagogical support to the teachers.
- Designed and implemented play-based activities aligned with students' learning objectives to enhance learning outcomes with limited resources.
- Conducted Teacher Competency Tests (TCT) across 14 partnered schools in Punjab and KPK.
- Developed Science Evaluation Tools (SET) for grades 3, 5, and 8.

Shangla Girls School- Zindagi Trust, Malala Fund – Shangla, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan

Website: https://www.zindagitrust.org/

Learning and Development Coach

[01/07/2021 – 30/06/2022]

Shangla Girls School, a free model school located in Malala Yousafzai's village of Shangla, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, is owned and funded by the Malala Fund and administered by Zindagi Trust.
Zindagi Trust works on improving education quality in low-resourced public schools, especially for girls, by transforming institutions into model schools through targeted academic and infrastructural interventions. It collaborates with educators, students, and communities to pilot and test innovative initiatives aimed at enhancing the quality of education.

I worked closely with the entire teaching staff, engaging with both children and teachers in particular.
Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Coached and assisted 12 primary and secondary grade teachers in the development and execution of individualized teacher progress plans tailored to address unique needs and challenges, fostering measurable growth in pedagogical skills and classroom management.
- Conducted in-depth coaching sessions on average twice per week, blending real-time classroom observations with reflective dialogue to build teachers' capacity for self-assessment and continuous improvement.
- Established a culture of reflective practice and peer learning, introducing structured feedback loops and peer observation protocols that led to sustainable professional growth.
- Designed and implemented age- and context-specific SEL activities for children and teachers.
- Strategized remedial class plans and developed basic literacy programs for children with learning gaps; on average, students jumped 3 grade levels in education.
- Collaborated with school leaders and stakeholders to align teacher development initiatives with school goals, contributing to outcomes like improved teacher retention, enhanced school culture, and better student engagement.
- Utilized data-driven insights to identify trends in teacher performance and implemented targeted interventions, increasing differentiated instruction and assessment practices.
- Organized community engagement activities and sessions to strengthen school-community relationships, promote the importance of education for out-of-school girls, and successfully increased parental participation in parent-teacher meetings by over 30% and enrollment by 26%.
- Served as a school counsellor for over 500 children for 8 months until the school officially hired a permanent counsellor.

Teach For Pakistan – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://www.iteachforpakistan.org/

Monitoring, Evaluation and Recruitment (Part-time)

- Critically reviewed 30 fellowship applicants' essays during the application process for the 2021 cohort.
- Assisted Teach For Pakistan in recruiting the 2021 and 2022 cohorts by evaluating the performance of over 65 candidates during the Assessment Centres.
- Observed the classrooms of 10 fellows of the 2022 cohort, provided mentorship, and conducted debrief sessions during their training institute.
- Reviewed final year Community Partnership Projects for the 2024 cohort.
- Conducted final interviews for the 2025 cohort.

Alliance for Urban Rights (AUR) – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: http://aurpk.org/

Research Assistant

[01/06/2020 – 30/11/2020]

Alliance for Urban Rights (AUR) is an action-oriented research and advocacy organization bridging the gap between activism and research. Its work focuses on the intersections of urban planning, climate, gender justice, and technology, particularly addressing the impacts of urban displacement and violence, with a focus on gendered effects. AUR is a network of activists, organizers, and researchers dedicated to issues of marginalization and rights.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Supported a qualitative research project by Goldsmiths, University of London, focused on the right to shelter.
- Conducted fieldwork in Islamabad's slum areas, collecting data through over 30 interviews and more than 200 surveys.
- Transcribed and translated 30 interviews for analysis.
- Organized various social and legal knowledge awareness workshops within the communities.

Teach For Pakistan – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://www.iteachforpakistan.org/

Leadership and Teaching Fellow

[01/06/2019 – 30/06/2021]

Teach for Pakistan is part of the Teach for All network, a global network of 53 independent organizations with a shared mission of expanding educational opportunities around the world. Member of selective corps **(3-5% selection rate)** of young college graduates placed for two years in under-resourced schools. As part of my two-year fellowship, I have:

- Worked on improving the English language, mathematics, science, social studies, and non-cognitive skills of around 190 students of second to fifth grades in IMSB Rawal Town, Islamabad, a public school in a low-income community.
- Developed learning objectives based on the National Curriculum and maintained individual tracking system in Excel for monitoring the academic performances of students in these objectives**.**
- Recording and analyzing academic results to design lessons and additional remedial and enrichment classes to bridge the average gap of more than 4 years between current and actual grade levels.
- Established community learning centres and conducted remedial classes incorporating SEL activities in collaboration with community members during COVID-19 school closures to reduce learning gaps and promote psychological well-being.
- Improved the pass rate from 35% to 70%, increased the average scores by around 30% in the academic year 2019-2020, and achieved an average student growth of 2 academic years in only five months.
- Mentored two new Fellows during the Summer Training Institute, 2020, to develop the required skills and knowledge based on 'Teaching as Leadership' and undertook classroom observations.
- Assessed and provided support to children with learning disabilities, such as dyslexia, in my classes.
- Established and organized a local pool of psychologists to support children with learning disabilities to ensure long-term sustainability.
- Developed a multimedia room in the school to transform learning methods aligned with modern and contemporary teaching methods and trained teachers on how to incorporate their daily lessons.
- Introduced and implemented customized classroom management plans for the first time in school and trained other teachers to effectively manage overcrowded classrooms, thereby reducing corporal punishment rates in school.
- Completed a two-month training program, "Scientists of Tomorrow," focused on enhancing classroom experiences for Fellows and students by making learning fun and engaging.
- Learned to design unconventional science lessons tailored for students in low-income communities to spark curiosity in science.
- Conducted Science Fuse's lessons for over 60 grade 4 science students.
- Pioneered the Teaching Assistant (TA) system in school, whereby responsibilities are delegated to high-performing students to hone their management and leadership skills and to build their confidence.

Rimsha Community School – Islamabad, Pakistan

Organizer, Founder and Teacher

[01/02/2018 – Current]

- In 2018, I founded and organized a community school in a Christian slum community in H-9, Islamabad, which had been displaced due to blasphemy allegations. The school operates in a community-shared space and, as of fall 2024, enrolls 168 students, primarily females who previously could not attend school due to proximity issues or responsibilities like babysitting younger siblings while their parents work. The school is staffed by six teachers from the same community.
- This year, for the first time, 26 girls from the school appeared in public intermediate exams, with 19 achieving good grades. Some of these girls will begin university in the spring term, while others are expected to start in the fall as scholarships are secured. These achievements represent a significant milestone, as many of these girls, if not in school, would have faced early marriages during their teenage years.
- I designed and implemented various SEL activities combined with parental engagement strategies to address school dropouts. After 8 months, these efforts successfully reduced the dropout rate by nearly half.
- I have introduced SEL activities in the curriculum at three different levels: early primary, late primary, and secondary years to support their resilience processes with systemic checklists in place. The activities are designed to develop collaboration, a growth mindset, problem-solving, empowerment, and autonomy.
- We collectively designed a community-fund system to run this school. Around 30% of the expenses are covered by minimal school fees, 50% by the community members as their monthly contributions, and the remaining by the private individual donors.

Workers' Academy – Islamabad, Pakistan

Organizer and Teacher

[01/05/2018 – Current]

I founded and organized a community school in G-7 Katchi Abadi, a slum community of Christian minorities. As of fall 2024, the school enrolls 73 students, primarily girls who work during the day and attend evening classes to learn basic literacy, numeracy, life skills, and SEL skills. The school is staffed by two part-time teachers from the community, both of whom are pursuing higher education at different universities.

Women Aid Trust – Islamabad/Rawalpindi, Pakistan

Junior Counselor

[01/09/2017 – 31/05/2018]

I worked as a junior counsellor in the juvenile ward at Adiala Central Jail, providing group counselling to 28 juveniles charged with petty crimes. In addition to conducting one-on-one sessions tailored to their individual needs, I organized and led mental health programs to support their well-being. Recognizing the lack of recreational opportunities, I successfully advocated for and provided a table tennis table to introduce a constructive activity, fostering a sense of resilience and engagement among the children.

Corona Solidarity and Flood Relief Campaign – Islamabad, Pakistan

Volunteer Focal person (Part-time)

[01/03/2020 – 30/11/2022]

Mutual aid and advocacy platform, providing assistance (mostly in form of rations and PPEs) to daily wage earners and vulnerable folks in squatter areas of Rawalpindi and Islamabad during Covid-19. Managed to provide constant monthly rations to 500 families of daily wage earners and slum communities for 22 months. Established women vocational center "Behan Chara'h" meaning Sisters' Solidarity, in Alipur Farash, a slum area, is now independently run by women of the community.

Organized fundraising locally and internationally with WDF in August 2022, and collected PKR ~40 million collectively. Provided immediate relief support to flood-stricken areas across cities and villages in Sindh, Baluchistan, KPK and Gilgit-Baltistan mostly in the form of cash, food, tents, warm clothing, shoes, and bedding. Collectively established a temporary learning center in Umarkot, dominated by a minority Hindu community, where ~100 out-of-school children are enrolled.

HeadStart School, Kuri Road Campus – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: http://headstart.edu.pk/kuri/

Special Educational Needs Therapist and Academic Behavioral Interventionist (Intern)

[01/01/2016 – 30/06/2016]

Intern with Autistic and delayed developmental disorder children, age group of 5 to 13 years old. Worked on the Picture-Autism technique and assisted Play Therapists in developing and implementing differentiated lesson plans.

Sahil Organization – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://sahil.org/

Volunteer

[01/02/2017 – 31/08/2017]

Assisted lead counselors in sessions with children to help in recovering from rape and sexual trauma. Conducted different mental health assessment tests.

Maroof International Hospital – Islamabad, Pakistan

Website: https://www.maroof.com.pk/

Shadow clinical psychologist (Intern)

[01/09/2016 – 31/12/2016]

Observed sessions of the children diagnosed with Autism, Learning disorders and Down Syndrome. Co-developed psychological assessment reports.

All Pakistan Alliance for Katchi Abadis (APAKA) – Islamabad, Pakistan

Volunteer (Part-time)

[01/08/2015 – 08/2023]

Working since late 2015 in different squatter settlements (Alipur Farash, H-9, G-7, G-8, F-6, F-7, I-9, I-10, I-11, G-11 and Mehra Abadi) of Islamabad. Developed and organized collective community spaces as daycares for working women and converted landfills into recreational sites and play areas for the children. Installed water hand pumps and solar panels in the informal settlements. Established trash and waste management system. Organized public sessions in the slum communities to provide social and legal education against harassment. Organized and managed medical camps in the communities.

Save Them All and HWO Animal Rescue – Registered – Islamabad, Pakistan

Founder, Organizer and Rescuer (Part-time)

[01/10/2015 – Current]

Founded and manages a small group of young volunteers called “Save Them All” working as stray animal rescuers. Organized and conducted workshops in public and private schools to highlight sensitivity towards street animals. Worked as an animal rescuer at HWO Animal Rescue.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Masters in Resilience in Educational Contexts

Erasmus Mundus Joint Master Degree- University of Lisbon, University of Malta, University of Crete [02/10/2023 – 08/09/2025]

City: Lisbon | **Country:** Portugal | **Website:** https://flourishproject.mt/ | **Final grade:** Distinction | **Thesis:** From Slums to School: Translation and cultural adaptation of the RESCUR Early Years and Primary School Resilience Curriculum in low-income/under-resourced community schools in Pakistan.

With a competitive **selection rate of 2-4%**, studied under the leading experts in the field, including professors Michael Ungar, Linda Theron, Renos Papadopoulos, and Carmel Cefai, among others.

Bachelor's in Psychology

COMSATS Univeristy [01/08/2013 – 30/08/2017]

City: Islamabad | **Country:** Pakistan | **Website:** https://www.comsats.edu.pk/ | **Final grade:** 3.4/4 | **Thesis:** Psychological well-being and perceived social support among Pakistani transgender.

Completed a 4-year bachelor's degree on scholarship and received an **award of distinction** in 2015.

ADVANCED TRAINING COURSE INTERNATIONAL CRIMINAL JURISDICTION AND CHILDREN IN ARMED CONFLICT

UNIVERSITIES NETWORK FOR CHILDREN IN ARMED CONFLICT [09/06/2025 – 13/06/2025]

City: Rome | **Country:** Italy | **Website:** www.uninetworkforchildren.org

Diploma in Philosophy of Education

Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS) [05/03/2022 – 15/05/2022]

Country: Pakistan | **Website:** https://lums.edu.pk/

An online course by Dr. Faisal Bari.

Course in GlobalEd- From Policy Framing to Implementation and Strategies for Education Access and Equity in Low-Resource Contexts

Central European University, Hungary [14/06/2022 – 01/07/2022]

City: Budapest | **Country:** Hungary | **Website:** https://www.ceu.edu/

It was based on two weeks of online and one week of fully sponsored in-person sessions.

Diploma in Gender and Feminism

Sangat [02/06/2020 – 20/08/2020]

Country: India | **Website:** https://sangatnetwork.org/

Studied under the renowned South Asian feminist Kamla Bhasin from India, with the fee waived.

Diploma in Political Theories

Escola Nacional Florestan Fernandes [03/11/2018 – 25/01/2019]

City: Sao Paulo | **Country:** Brazil

Participated in a fully sponsored, in-person program with 304 credit hours, alongside 30 young political activists from around the globe.

Online course in Development of Dialogues in Education

Aga Khan University [01/10/2021 – 20/11/2021]

Country: Pakistan | **Website:** https://www.aku.edu/Pages/home.aspx

Diploma in Organizational Psychology

Pakistan Institute of Management [01/08/2018 – 30/10/2018]

City: Karachi | **Country:** Pakistan | **Website:** https://www.pim.com.pk/

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): Gujarati | Urdu

Other language(s):

English

LISTENING C1 **READING** C1 **WRITING** B2

SPOKEN PRODUCTION B2 **SPOKEN INTERACTION** B2

Persian

LISTENING A2 **READING** A1 **WRITING** A1

SPOKEN PRODUCTION A2 **SPOKEN INTERACTION** B1

Portuguese

SPOKEN INTERACTION A1

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

SKILLS

Statistical analyses softwares (SPSS, R / R Studio, Amos, NVivo)

PROJECTS

[10/2024 – Current]
Research: Resilience and stress among educators and staff in foster homes: Implications for child welfare in Lisbon Currently collaborating on research with Prof. Teresa Cortim at the University of Lisbon, focusing on resilience and perceived stress among primary and secondary contacts of foster children and their implications on these children in foster homes in Lisbon, Portugal.

[18/01/2024 – 30/01/2024]
Erasmus+ Project - Breaking the burnout cycle 28 students from different countries across Europe gathered together to collectively develop a program and strategies that would help to be vigilant about the burnout phases, especially among educators and teaching staff, and how to overcome them in the most effective ways in their socio-cultural contexts.

[01/02/2016 – 25/06/2016]
Qualitative Research: Reasons of teenage suicide in Islamabad, Pakistan Under the supervision of Dr. Aliya Moeen Zafar, head of the humanities department at COMSATS University, Islamabad, I conducted qualitative research on the causes of teen suicide.